

UPSC Weekly Current Affairs — Week 40 · 28 Sept – 4 Oct 2026

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Exam digest: the 50 most exam-relevant of 214 notes this period, grouped by GS paper and subject.

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GS1 · History · Society · Geography · 2

History & Culture

Ancient & medieval India · Prelims + Mains · 29 Sept

NCERT Replaces European Revolutions with Medieval India History in Class 9 Textbook

Why in news: NCERT released a new Class 9 Social Science textbook replacing European revolutions with Indian medieval resistance movements to emphasize indigenous history.

Key facts: The NCERT released the new textbook on September 29, 2026. It covers the period between 1,000 and 1,700 CE, focusing on the Sikh Gurus' persecution and the Jat Uprising of 1669.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** NCERT: National Council of Educational Research and Training is the apex body for school education curriculum in India
- **Fact:** Jat Uprising: A significant regional resistance movement occurred in 1669
- **Fact:** The new curriculum focuses on the period between 1,000 and 1,700 CE

Mains question: Discuss the significance of decolonizing the Indian school curriculum by shifting focus from Western revolutions to indigenous medieval resistance movements.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127859

Five new sites, including Udaigiri Caves, added to India's UNESCO World Heritage tentative list

Why in news: The Government of India added five new sites, including the Udaigiri Caves and Satyagraha sites, to the UNESCO World Heritage tentative list.

Key facts: India now has a total of 78 sites on the UNESCO World Heritage tentative list. The new additions include Bagh Cave Paintings, Group of Temples of Chambal Valley, Ginnorgarh Fort, and a transnational proposal on Satyagraha sites.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** UNESCO: United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
- **Place:** Udaigiri Caves: Located in the state of Madhya Pradesh
- **Fact:** India's total tentative list count: 78 sites
- **Place:** Ginnorgarh Fort: Located in the state of Rajasthan

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the UNESCO World Heritage status in promoting cultural preservation and boosting heritage tourism in India.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128055

GS2 · Polity · Governance · IR · 22

Polity & Constitution

Supreme Court Questions How Minors Can Have Social Media Accounts

Why in news: The Supreme Court questioned the legality of minors holding social media accounts, noting that contracts entered by minors are void ab initio.

Key facts: The Supreme Court heard a plea from the NGO 'Just Rights for Children Alliance' regarding digital safeguards for children. The court directed social media platforms to adopt an 18-year age threshold for memberships.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** Supreme Court of India: The highest judicial body in India.
- **Fact:** Minors are legally incompetent to enter into binding contracts in India.
- **Fact:** The court directed an 18-year age threshold for social media memberships.

Mains question: Discuss the legal and ethical challenges posed by the digital presence of minors and the necessity of robust regulatory frameworks to ensure child safety online.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127323

Supreme Court Collegium recommends three High Court Chiefs for top judge roles

Why in news: The Supreme Court Collegium recommended three High Court Chief Justices for elevation to the Supreme Court, highlighting the judicial appointment process.

Key facts: The Collegium, consisting of the Chief Justice of India and four other judges, recommended Justice Sunita Agarwal (Gujarat), Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya (Delhi), and Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh (Telangana) for elevation. The recommendation follows the established procedure for judicial appointments in India.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** The Collegium system is the mechanism used by the Supreme Court of India to recommend names for judgeships.
- **Post:** The Collegium currently comprises the Chief Justice of India and four other senior-most judges.
- **Fact:** The three recommended judges represent the Gujarat, Delhi, and Telangana High Courts.

Mains question: Critically examine the Collegium system of judicial appointments in India. Does it ensure transparency and accountability in the higher judiciary?

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127339

HLCDC Seeks 15-Year Religion-Wise Data, Struggling States Face Constitutional Hurdles

Why in news: The High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes (HLCDC) requested religion-wise data from states, sparking a debate on the constitutionality of such data collection.

Key facts: The HLCDC was formed by the Ministry of Home Affairs to study demographic changes over a 15-year period. It requested data on birth/vehicle registrations, school enrolments, property transactions, and religious conversions among Scheduled Tribes.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** HLCDC: High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes formed by the Ministry of Home Affairs
- **Fact:** The committee seeks data spanning a 15-year period to analyze demographic trends
- **Place:** The committee visited Jammu and is scheduled to visit Maharashtra

Mains question: Discuss the constitutional and ethical implications of collecting religion-based demographic data by the state. Does such data collection compromise the principle of secularism?

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127345

Supreme Court Orders Delhi Police to Audit Lighting, CCTV After Recent Rapes

Why in news: The Supreme Court took suo motu cognizance of sexual assault incidents in Delhi-NCR, directing the Delhi Police to audit infrastructure and enhance patrolling to ensure the right to life and dignity.

Key facts: On September 28, 2026, the Supreme Court ordered the Delhi Police to audit lighting and CCTV coverage within four weeks. The court specifically cited incidents at Astha Kunj park and Swaroop Nagar as reasons for the intervention.

Prelims pointers

- **Constitution:** Article 21: Guarantees the right to life and personal liberty, which includes the right to live with dignity.
- **Body:** Delhi Police: The primary law enforcement agency for the National Capital Territory of Delhi.
- **Fact:** The court mandated a four-week timeline for the audit of lighting and CCTV coverage.

Mains question: Discuss the role of the judiciary in ensuring the right to safety and dignity for women in urban spaces. How can proactive policing mitigate crimes against women?

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127393

Ladakh Demands Sixth Schedule Status, MHA Proposes Directly Elected Body

Why in news: The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) proposed a directly elected legislative body for Ladakh as an alternative to the Sixth Schedule status demanded by locals.

Key facts: The Union Territory of Ladakh is seeking Sixth Schedule status for greater autonomy. The MHA has proposed a directly elected legislative body and the introduction of Article 371-K to balance local representation with national security concerns near the China border.

Prelims pointers

- **Constitution:** Sixth Schedule: Provides autonomy to tribal areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram.
- **Body:** Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA): Responsible for internal security and border management.
- **Fact:** Article 371-K: Proposed provision to provide special provisions for Ladakh.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges of balancing regional autonomy with national security concerns in strategically sensitive border regions like Ladakh.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127471

In August 2026, the Supreme Court asked Union Ministries to address doxxing and deepfakes

Why in news: The Supreme Court directed Union Ministries to address doxxing and deepfakes following a PIL regarding surveillance and privacy rights.

Key facts: The Supreme Court heard a PIL filed by Rajya Sabha member A.A. Rahim against the Delhi Police's use of facial recognition technology. The court also upheld the Election Commission's Special Intensive

Revision (SIR) conducted in May 2026.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** Supreme Court of India: The highest judicial body in India.
- **S&T:** Deepfakes: Synthetic media in which a person in an existing image or video is replaced by someone else's likeness.
- **S&T:** Doxxing: The act of publicly revealing private personal information about an individual without consent.
- **Fact:** Special Intensive Revision (SIR): A process used by the Election Commission for voter list updates.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges posed by deepfakes and doxxing to the right to privacy and the necessity of a robust legal framework to regulate AI-driven surveillance.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/128025](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/128025)

Elections, ECI & electoral reforms · Prelims + Mains · 30 Sept

Election Chief Faces Petition for Database Tampering, Voter Disenfranchisement

Why in news: A petition was filed in the Supreme Court seeking an independent audit of Election Commission databases and the removal of statutory immunity for the CEC over alleged electoral roll tampering.

Key facts: The petition alleges unilateral alterations in voter registration and software failures leading to disenfranchisement. It cites Section 32 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950, and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) regarding cognisable offences.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** Representation of the People Act, 1950: Governs the preparation and maintenance of electoral rolls.
- **Constitution:** Article 361: Provides immunity to the President and Governors; the petition argues CEC should not have similar immunity.
- **Body:** Election Commission of India (ECI): Constitutional body responsible for administering elections.
- **Fact:** Section 32 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950: Deals with offences related to electoral rolls.

Mains question: Discuss the importance of electoral integrity and the role of independent audits in ensuring the sanctity of the democratic process in India.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/128140](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/128140)

Fundamental rights, DPSP & duties · Prelims + Mains · 30 Sept

Supreme Court to Examine Threat to Press Freedom in The Hindu Case

Why in news: The Supreme Court will examine the conflict between legislative privileges and freedom of the press in a 2003 case involving *The Hindu* and the Tamil Nadu Assembly.

Key facts: The case involves a 2003 resolution by the Tamil Nadu Assembly to arrest editorial staff of *The Hindu* for breaching legislative privileges. The Supreme Court has scheduled a seven-judge Bench to hear the matter on October 6, 2026, to determine the harmonious reading of Article 19(1)(a) and Article 194(3).

Prelims pointers

- **Constitution:** Article 19(1)(a): Guarantees freedom of speech and expression, including freedom of the press.
- **Constitution:** Article 194(3): Relates to the privileges of the House of the Legislature of a State.
- **Body:** Supreme Court: The highest judicial body in India, empowered to adjudicate on the constitutionality of legislative actions.

Mains question: Examine the constitutional conflict between the privileges of the legislature and the fundamental right to freedom of the press in India.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/128174](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/128174)

Governance

Bills, Acts & ordinances · Prelims + Mains · 29 Sept

Union Government Seeks Supreme Court Stay on Great Nicobar Island Project Petitions

Why in news: The Union government moved the Supreme Court to stay hearings on the ₹92,000-crore Great Nicobar project due to allegations of violating the Forest Rights Act (FRA).

Key facts: The project is valued at ₹92,000 crore. The petitioner, Meena Gupta (retired IAS), alleges violations of the Forest Rights Act (FRA) regarding consent for the project. The Supreme Court is set to hear the Special Leave Petition (SLP) on October 5.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** Forest Rights Act (FRA): Legislation providing forest-dwelling communities with legal rights over forest land.
- **Fact:** Great Nicobar Project: A mega-infrastructure project estimated at ₹92,000 crore.
- **Place:** Great Nicobar Island: An island in the Andaman and Nicobar archipelago.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges in balancing large-scale infrastructure development with the protection of tribal rights and forest conservation under the Forest Rights Act.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/127949](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127949)

Social Justice

Health policy & public health · Prelims + Mains · 28 Sept

A retired bank employee suffering from breast cancer approached the Kerala High Court

Why in news: The Kerala High Court ruled that the central government can manufacture or authorize production of patented life-saving medicines at non-commercial rates for needy patients.

Key facts: The ruling was delivered by Justice Harisankar V Menon on September 16, 2022, regarding the drug Ribociclib. It invoked Section 100 of the Patents Act, 1970, to allow production of patented medicines for affordable access.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** Patents Act, 1970: Governs the granting of patents and the rights of patent holders in India.
- **Fact:** Section 100 of the Patents Act: Provides for the compulsory licensing of patented inventions for the purpose of public health or national security.
- **Body:** Kerala High Court: The judicial body that issued the ruling regarding affordable access to life-saving drugs.

Mains question: Discuss the balance between protecting intellectual property rights and ensuring the right to health for marginalized sections in India.

Source: NDTV · [satyadheesh.in/news/127059](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127059)

Health policy & public health · Prelims + Mains · 28 Sept

India Had 50 Million Schoolchildren Without Sanitation in 2025: WHO/UNICEF Report

Why in news: A WHO/UNICEF report highlights that 50 million Indian schoolchildren still lack sanitation services despite progress under the Swachh Bharat Mission.

Key facts: The WHO/UNICEF report (Sept 2026) states India has the highest number of schoolchildren without sanitation services globally (50 million out of 244 million). While drinking water access improved, significant rural-urban gaps persist in hygiene services.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** WHO and UNICEF are the primary bodies responsible for the report on global school sanitation.
- **Scheme:** Swachh Bharat Mission was launched in 2014 to improve sanitation and hygiene.
- **Fact:** India has 50 million schoolchildren without sanitation services as of 2025.
- **Fact:** Only 12 million Indian children lack access to basic drinking water in schools.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges in achieving universal sanitation in rural schools and suggest measures to bridge the rural-urban hygiene gap in India.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/127213](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127213)

India's Orphan Drug Potential: 1,004 Rare Disorders, \$100,000+ Treatments Await Solutions

Why in news: The article highlights India's potential to become a global hub for orphan drug manufacturing to address 1,004 rare genetic disorders.

Key facts: India reports 1,004 rare genetic disorders where treatments can cost over \$100,000 annually. The Orphan Drug Act of 1983 provides tax breaks and market exclusivity to incentivize development.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** Orphan Drug Act (1983) provides tax breaks and market exclusivity for rare disease drugs
- **Fact:** India supports rare disease patients with subsidies up to Rs 50 lakh
- **Fact:** U.S. approved 1,122 orphan drugs post-Act implementation by 2022

Mains question: Discuss the challenges and opportunities for India in developing a robust ecosystem for orphan drugs to address the healthcare needs of patients with rare diseases.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127540

International Relations

India's bilateral relations · Prelims · 29 Sept

UAE to invest additional \$25 billion in India, aiming for \$100 billion total

Why in news: The UAE announced a \$25 billion investment in India's infrastructure and technology sectors, aiming to reach a \$100 billion total investment target.

Key facts: The announcement was made by Union Minister Piyush Goyal during the 14th High-Level Joint Task Force meeting. The agreement targets cooperation in ports, shipbuilding, energy security, space technology, and financial services.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** UAE's total investment target in India: \$100 billion
- **Fact:** Target bilateral trade between India and UAE: \$200 billion by 2032
- **Fact:** New investment tranche announced: \$25 billion
- **Fact:** Key sectors for cooperation: Ports, shipbuilding, energy security, space technology, and financial services

Mains question: Discuss the significance of India's deepening economic and technological ties with the UAE in the context of India's 'Look West' policy and energy security.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127405

India's bilateral relations · Prelims · 29 Sept

Houthi Capture Yemen Ports with IRGC Help, Control Strategic Strait

Why in news: Houthi rebels captured key Yemeni ports with reported IRGC assistance, threatening maritime security in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait.

Key facts: The Houthi group (Ansar Allah) seized Mocha, Dhufar, and Mayyun Island in September 2024. The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) is alleged to have provided advisory and communication support for the offensive.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Bab al-Mandeb Strait: A strategic maritime choke point connecting the Red Sea to the Gulf of Aden.
- **Fact:** Ansar Allah (Houthis): A militant group in Yemen supported by Iran.
- **S&T:** IRGC: The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps is an elite branch of the Iranian Armed Forces.

Mains question: Analyze the impact of the Houthi-led maritime disruptions on global trade routes and India's energy security.

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/127741

India's bilateral relations · Prelims · 29 Sept

India Talks with China to Use Xinjiang Airspace; Flights Set to Resume

Why in news: India and China are negotiating the use of Xinjiang airspace as an alternative route for Indian airlines following Pakistan's airspace ban.

Key facts: India is exploring the Hotan route via Xinjiang to bypass Pakistan's airspace restrictions. China Southern Airlines announced the resumption of direct flights between Guangzhou and New Delhi starting September 21.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** China Southern Airlines resumed direct flights between Guangzhou and New Delhi from September 21.
- **Place:** Hotan is a city in the Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region of China.
- **Fact:** IndiGo and Air India have resumed services to China as part of restored air links.

Mains question: Discuss how the restoration of air connectivity and airspace negotiations between India and China reflect the evolving dynamics of bilateral relations and regional logistics.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127753

India's bilateral relations · Prelims · 29 Sept

Japan urges India to speed up UNICORN radar deal amid Quad naval plans

Why in news: Japan urged India to fast-track the UNICORN naval radar agreement to enhance maritime security and military collaboration under FOIP principles.

Key facts: The UNICORN naval radar agreement was signed during PM Sanae Takaichi's visit in July 2026. Japan also announced plans for Quad naval exercises near the Sea of Japan and revisions to defense documents due to West Asia and Ukraine conflicts.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** FOIP: Free and Open Indo-Pacific is a strategic framework for maritime security and regional cooperation.
- **Fact:** The UNICORN naval radar agreement is a bilateral defense cooperation between India and Japan.
- **Place:** The Sea of Japan is a key maritime zone for Quad naval exercises.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the UNICORN naval radar agreement and the FOIP framework in strengthening India-Japan maritime security cooperation.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127916

Regional & global groupings (QUAD, BRICS, SCO, G20...) · Prelims + Mains · 29 Sept

Pakistan hosts SCO preparatory meeting; India attends amid Kashmir tensions

Why in news: India participated in an SCO preparatory meeting in Islamabad for the first time since Operation Sindoor, highlighting complex dynamics between multilateral cooperation and bilateral tensions.

Key facts: Pakistan announced it will host the SCO Summit in August 2027. The three-day SCO National Coordinators' meeting began on September 29, 2026, in Islamabad.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** SCO: Shanghai Cooperation Organisation is a Eurasian political, economic, and security alliance.
- **Fact:** Pakistan is scheduled to host the SCO Summit in August 2027.
- **Place:** Islamabad: Capital of Pakistan where the preparatory meeting was held.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges India faces in balancing multilateral engagements within the SCO while navigating bilateral tensions and security concerns in the region.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127931

India's bilateral relations · Prelims + Mains · 30 Sept

US pauses record USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan as trade bargaining chip

Why in news: The US paused a record USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan during a summit with China as a trade bargaining chip, signaling a shift in US-China-India dynamics.

Key facts: Donald Trump and Xi Jinping met in Washington to extend a trade truce by two months and establish an agricultural working group. The US paused a USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan as part of 'repricing' negotiations with China.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** The US paused a USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan as a bargaining chip during negotiations with China.
- **Fact:** The US and China extended their trade truce by two months following the Washington summit.

- **Place:** Donald Trump is scheduled to visit China for the APEC summit in November 2025.
- **Place:** Xi Jinping is scheduled to attend the G20 summit in Miami in December 2025.
- **Fact:** India faced a 50% tariff hike on its goods by the US in August 2025.

Mains question: Analyze how the shift in US-China relations towards 'managed competition' impacts India's strategic autonomy and its position in the Indo-Pacific region.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128416

Policies of other countries affecting India · Prelims + Mains · 1 Oct

Trump signs White House Accord on Super Intelligence with Meta, Nvidia, and Google

Why in news: President Donald Trump signed the 'White House Accord on Super Intelligence' with major AI firms (Meta, Nvidia, Google, etc.) to establish voluntary guardrails and oversight for advanced AI development.

Key facts: The accord involves major tech entities including Meta, Nvidia, Google, OpenAI, xAI, and Anthropic. It mandates internal guardrails, independent audits, and oversight committees. Simultaneously, the 'Ban Artificial Superintelligence Act' was proposed by lawmakers as a legislative counter-measure.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** White House Accord on Super Intelligence: A voluntary pact between the US government and major AI firms for safety oversight.
- **S&T:** OpenAI, xAI, and Anthropic: Key private entities involved in the development of Large Language Models and Super Intelligence.
- **Act / Bill:** Ban Artificial Superintelligence Act: A legislative proposal aimed at prohibiting the development of super-intelligent AI systems.

Mains question: Discuss the necessity of multi-stakeholder governance frameworks in regulating Artificial Super Intelligence to balance technological innovation with global safety standards.

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/128627

India's bilateral relations · Prelims + Mains · 1 Oct

Narendra Modi and Donald Trump had a productive telephone call reviewing bilateral ties, trade

Why in news: PM Modi and Donald Trump held a telephone call to review bilateral ties and trade amidst discussions on the Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act.

Key facts: The Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act proposes a mandate for up to 100% tariffs on goods from India, China, and other nations importing Russian oil. The call covered key sectors including defense, energy, and critical technologies.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** The Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act proposes tariffs of up to 100% on specific imports.
- **Post:** S. Jaishankar serves as the External Affairs Minister of India.
- **Body:** The act targets countries importing Russian oil as a means of economic pressure.

Mains question: Analyze how the proposed Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act could impact India's strategic autonomy and its energy security goals.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128655

Policies of other countries affecting India · Prelims + Mains · 1 Oct

Russia warns NATO it will use entire arsenal including nuclear weapons over Kaliningrad blockade

Why in news: Russia issued a diplomatic memo to NATO threatening the use of its entire arsenal, including nuclear weapons, in response to potential blockades of the Kaliningrad exclave.

Key facts: Russia warned NATO of nuclear escalation regarding the Kaliningrad region. NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte dismissed the threats as unhelpful. The incident occurred amidst heightened air defenses in Poland and maritime friction near Denmark.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Kaliningrad: A Russian exclave located on the Baltic Sea, bordering Poland and Lithuania.
- **Post:** Mark Rutte: The current Secretary-General of NATO.
- **Fact:** Russia's nuclear arsenal is the largest in the world, governed by various arms control treaties.

Mains question: Analyze the implications of the escalating Russia-NATO tensions in the Baltic region on European security architecture and global nuclear non-proliferation norms.

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/128679

India's bilateral relations · Prelims + Mains · 1 Oct

Piyush Goyal meets Jamieson Greer to discuss interim trade agreement amid US tariff changes

Why in news: Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal met U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer to negotiate an interim trade agreement amidst shifting U.S. tariff policies.

Key facts: The meeting took place on September 30, 2026, in Milwaukee. India is seeking competitive advantages over ASEAN countries, China, and Bangladesh despite a framework established in February 2026.

Prelims pointers

- **Post:** Jamieson Greer: U.S. Trade Representative (USTR)
- **Fact:** Meeting date: September 30, 2026
- **Fact:** India's trade competitors in this context: ASEAN, China, and Bangladesh

Mains question: Analyze the challenges India faces in securing favorable trade terms with the United States amidst fluctuating global tariff regimes and regional competition.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128774

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Economy

Monetary policy, RBI & banking · Prelims + Mains · 28 Sept

Rupee Hits Record Low, RBI Interventions Cost \$14.8 Billion

Why in news: The RBI's intervention to stabilize the Indian Rupee against a strengthening US Dollar led to a significant reduction in foreign exchange reserves.

Key facts: The Indian Rupee hit a record low in May 2025. The RBI's intervention to curb depreciation resulted in a reduction of \$14.8 billion in its reserves. Experts noted a negative balance of payments excluding foreign currency inflows.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** RBI: The central bank of India responsible for monetary policy and managing foreign exchange reserves.
- **Fact:** The RBI's reserves were reduced by \$14.8 billion due to currency interventions.
- **Fact:** The rupee's depreciation was noted to have potentially overcorrected by up to 13%.

Mains question: Analyze the impact of a strengthening US Dollar on India's balance of payments and the role of the RBI in managing currency volatility.

Source: Economic Times · satyadheesh.in/news/126899

Industry, investment & MSMEs · Prelims · 28 Sept

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) introduced the Telecom Consumer Protection (Thirteenth Amendment) Regulations

Why in news: TRAI introduced the Telecom Consumer Protection (Thirteenth Amendment) Regulations, 2026, to mandate voice and SMS-only plans with proportional tariff reductions to lower consumer costs.

Key facts: The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) issued the Thirteenth Amendment Regulations in 2026. The regulations require telecom operators to offer plans with validity periods aligned with monthly expectations and proportional tariff reductions for voice/SMS-only options.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** TRAI: An independent statutory body established to regulate the telecommunications sector in India.
- **Fact:** The Thirteenth Amendment Regulations, 2026, mandate proportional tariff reductions for voice and SMS-only plans.
- **Fact:** The regulations aim to align plan validity periods with monthly consumer usage expectations.

Mains question: Discuss how regulatory interventions by bodies like TRAI can balance the interests of telecom service providers and consumer welfare in a digital economy.

Monetary policy, RBI & banking · Prelims + Mains · 28 Sept

Supreme Court Rejects Plea to Halt 0.4% UPI Charge on Big Transactions

Why in news: The Supreme Court questioned the legal status of the 0.4% UPI merchant discount rate (MDR) as a potential 'expropriation' and its impact on the formal economy.

Key facts: The government proposed a 0.4% charge on UPI person-to-merchant transactions exceeding ₹2,000 starting October 15, 2026. The Supreme Court has sought counter affidavits from the Union of India, RBI, and NPCI regarding the legality and economic impact of this levy.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India) is the primary body for operating the UPI infrastructure.
- **Fact:** The proposed UPI Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) is 0.4% for transactions above ₹2,000.
- **Body:** RBI (Reserve Bank of India) is the regulatory authority for the Indian payment systems.

Mains question: Discuss the implications of imposing Merchant Discount Rates (MDR) on UPI transactions on the growth of a cashless economy and the potential for informalization.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127109

Industry, investment & MSMEs · Prelims + Mains · 30 Sept

India Aims for 10 GW Polysilicon by August to Cut China Dependence

Why in news: The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy is developing an incentive scheme to boost domestic polysilicon production to reduce India's heavy reliance on Chinese imports.

Key facts: India currently has over 213 GW of solar module manufacturing capacity and 32 GW of cell capacity. The government aims for 10 GW of polysilicon production by August and a target of 30 GW by 2030.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India's current solar module manufacturing capacity exceeds 213 GW.
- **Fact:** Target for domestic polysilicon production is 30 GW by 2030.
- **Body:** Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) is the nodal ministry for solar incentives.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of developing a domestic solar supply chain in India to achieve energy security and reduce import dependencies.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128134

Industry, investment & MSMEs · Prelims + Mains · 30 Sept

Centre notifies CAFE-3 norms: Fuel benchmark to drop 16.7% by 2031-32

Why in news: The Centre notified CAFE-3 norms for passenger vehicles to mandate a 16.7% reduction in fuel consumption benchmarks by 2031-32 to promote cleaner automotive technologies.

Key facts: The CAFE-3 norms apply to all new passenger vehicles manufactured or imported for sale in India starting April 1, 2027. The benchmark drops from 3.996 litres/100 km in 2027-28 to 3.3273 litres/100 km by 2031-32. The reference weight for calculations is increased from 1,082 kg to 1,229 kg.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** CAFE-3 fuel benchmark: 3.3273 litres per 100 km by 2031-32
- **Fact:** Reference weight increase: From 1,082 kg to 1,229 kg under CAFE-3
- **S&T:** Carbon Neutrality Factor (CNF): A mechanism providing concessions for eligible cleaner technologies
- **Fact:** Implementation period: April 1, 2027, to March 31, 2032

Mains question: Discuss how the CAFE-3 norms align with India's commitment to decarbonizing the transport sector while balancing industrial growth and technological adoption.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128231

Growth, inflation & macro indicators · Prelims + Mains · 30 Sept

India to become "super-aged" by 2065 as fertility rate hits 1.9

Why in news: A Moody's report warns that India's rapid fertility decline (1.9) will lead to a 'super-aged' demographic status by 2065, posing a risk of aging before achieving high-income status.

Key facts: India's Total Fertility Rate (TFR) is currently 1.9, dropping to 1.6 if Bihar and Uttar Pradesh are excluded. The report projects India will transition from 'aged' in 2049 to 'super-aged' by 2065, a much faster transition than the US or Indonesia.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India's current Total Fertility Rate (TFR) is 1.9.
- **Fact:** India is projected to become 'super-aged' by the year 2065.
- **Fact:** Annual births in India have dropped to 2.32 crore.
- **Fact:** Replacement level fertility is generally considered to be 2.1 children per woman.

Mains question: Discuss the economic implications of India's rapidly aging demographic profile and the necessity of increasing female labor force participation to sustain growth.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128332

Infrastructure (energy, ports, roads, railways) · Prelims + Mains · 30 Sept

Modi's Union Cabinet approves ₹1,86,405 crore for Green Energy Corridor Phase-III scheme

Why in news: The Union Cabinet approved the 'Green Energy Corridor Phase-III' scheme with a ₹1,86,405 crore outlay to facilitate the evacuation of renewable energy and enhance storage capacity.

Key facts: The scheme allocates ₹1,36,378 crore for Intra-State Transmission Systems and ₹50,000 crore for 50 GWh of Battery Energy Storage Systems. It aims to evacuate 135 GW of renewable energy by FY 2032-33 to support India's 500 GW renewable target by 2030.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Total outlay for Green Energy Corridor Phase-III: ₹1,86,405 crore
- **Fact:** Target for renewable energy evacuation: 135 GW by FY 2032-33
- **Fact:** Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) target: 50 GWh
- **Fact:** India's non-fossil fuel capacity target: 900 GW by 2035

Mains question: Examine how the development of Green Energy Corridors and Battery Energy Storage Systems is essential for achieving India's ambitious non-fossil fuel capacity targets by 2035.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128352

Industry, investment & MSMEs · Prelims + Mains · 1 Oct

India proposes \$25 billion pool to support Deep Tech startups and reduce foreign dependence

Why in news: India proposed a \$25 billion fund to support Deep Tech startups to reduce reliance on foreign technology, as highlighted by the IVCA-Venture Intelligence Bharat DeepTech Report 2026.

Key facts: The proposed \$25 billion pool will combine government funding, private equity, and venture capital. The IVCA-Venture Intelligence Bharat DeepTech Report 2026 noted \$11.4 billion in funding across 957 deals between 2015 and July 2026.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Proposed Deep Tech fund size: \$25 billion
- **Body:** IVCA: Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association
- **Fact:** Total funding recorded between 2015 and July 2026: \$11.4 billion
- **Fact:** Number of Deep Tech deals recorded by July 2026: 957

Mains question: Discuss how fostering a robust Deep Tech ecosystem can enhance India's technological sovereignty and reduce its dependence on foreign intellectual property.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128688

Growth, inflation & macro indicators · Prelims · 1 Oct

India's external debt rose \$15.4 billion to \$778.2 billion by end-June

Why in news: RBI data revealed a rise in India's external debt to \$778.2 billion by June 2024, reflecting the country's evolving debt-to-GDP dynamics.

Key facts: India's external debt reached \$778.2 billion by end-June 2024, a rise of \$15.4 billion. The debt-to-GDP ratio moderated to 20.8%, while invisible receipts stood at \$163 billion.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India's total external debt reached \$778.2 billion by June 2024.
- **Fact:** India's debt-to-GDP ratio moderated to 20.8% as of June 2024.

- **Fact:** August 2024 services trade exports were \$35.5 billion against \$18.9 billion imports.
- **Body:** The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is the primary authority for monitoring external debt and debt-to-GDP ratios.

Mains question: Analyze the factors influencing India's external debt dynamics and discuss the implications of a moderating debt-to-GDP ratio on India's macroeconomic stability.

Source: Economic Times · satyadheesh.in/news/128726

Growth, inflation & macro indicators · Prelims + Mains · 1 Oct

India's economy faces risks as crude oil prices jump 28.66% to \$116.04

Why in news: The Finance Ministry flagged risks to India's economy due to a 28.66% surge in crude oil prices in September and potential US-led trade restrictions on Russian crude.

Key facts: India's crude oil basket jumped from \$90.19 per barrel in August to \$116.04 per barrel in September. Real GDP grew by 7.8% in Q1 FY27, with manufacturing growing at 9.2% and services at 12.1%.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India's crude oil basket price in September: \$116.04 per barrel
- **Fact:** Real GDP growth rate in Q1 FY27: 7.8%
- **Fact:** Indian crude basket composition: Sweet crude (Brent-based) and Sour crude (Oman and Dubai grades)
- **Fact:** Manufacturing growth rate in Q1 FY27: 9.2%

Mains question: Analyze how volatile global energy prices and geopolitical trade shifts impact India's fiscal stability and domestic inflation targets.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128822

Monetary policy, RBI & banking · Prelims + Mains · 1 Oct

80% of Mumbaikars refuse 0.4% MDR on UPI payments above ₹2,000

Why in news: The Ministry of Finance notified a framework to introduce a 0.4% Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI payments above ₹2,000, sparking consumer resistance and merchant pushback.

Key facts: The Ministry of Finance notified S.O. 5067(E) on September 14, 2026, making the 0.4% MDR effective from October 15, 2026. The MDR is capped at ₹300 per transaction for payments of ₹75,000 and above, ending over six years of zero MDR on UPI.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** MDR of 0.4% applies to person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI payments above ₹2,000 starting October 15, 2026
- **Fact:** MDR is capped at ₹300 per transaction for payments of ₹75,000 and above
- **Fact:** Maharashtra accounted for 9.84% of UPI transactions by volume as of April 2026
- **Body:** NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India) provides state-wise UPI transaction data

Mains question: Discuss the economic implications of transitioning from a zero-MDR model to a fee-based structure for UPI payments on the digital economy and financial inclusion.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128866

Employment & inclusive growth · Prelims + Mains · 1 Oct

Households without biometric Aadhaar authentication to receive only 5kg or 10kg cylinders

Why in news: The Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas mandated that households lacking biometric Aadhaar authentication (BAA) will only receive 5kg or 10kg cylinders at market prices to ensure subsidy integrity.

Key facts: The mandate requires Indian Oil, BPCL, and HPCL to enforce BAA for subsidy eligibility. In Telangana, approximately 11 lakh users were identified as lacking eKYC, leading to the cancellation of their orders.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** Indian Oil, BPCL, and HPCL are the three major public sector oil marketing companies in India.
- **Fact:** The mandate restricts households without BAA to 5kg or 10kg cylinders at market prices.
- **Post:** The Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas oversees the distribution of LPG subsidies.

Mains question: Discuss how the integration of biometric authentication in Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) schemes balances the objective of subsidy leakage prevention with the challenge of digital exclusion.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129190

Agriculture

MSP, procurement, PDS & food security · Prelims + Mains · 30 Sept

Modi cabinet approves rabi crop MSP hikes with ₹90,962 crore farmer payout

Why in news: The Union Cabinet approved increased Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for six Rabi crops for the 2027-28 marketing year to ensure farmer profitability.

Key facts: The Cabinet approved a total farmer payout of ₹90,962 crore for 324 lakh tonnes of produce. The MSP for wheat was hiked by ₹25 per quintal to ₹2,610, while masur saw a significant hike of ₹390 per quintal.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Wheat MSP for 2027-28 rabi marketing year: ₹2,610 per quintal
- **Fact:** Masur MSP for 2027-28 rabi marketing year: ₹7,390 per quintal
- **Body:** CACP (Commission for Agricultural Costs & Prices) provides recommendations for MSP fixing
- **Fact:** Total estimated farmer payout for 2027-28 rabi crops: ₹90,962 crore
- **Fact:** Wheat production target for 2026-27 crop year: 121 million tonnes

Mains question: Critically examine the role of Minimum Support Price (MSP) in ensuring food security and farmer welfare while addressing the fiscal implications on the national exchequer.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128358

Science & Technology

Defence technology · Prelims + Mains · 28 Sept

India to Buy 114 Rafales for Rs 3.25 Lakh Crore Amid Tejas Delays

Why in news: India is negotiating a ₹3.25 lakh crore deal for 114 Rafale jets to address squadron shortages caused by delays in indigenous Tejas production.

Key facts: The Defence Secretary announced a potential acquisition of 114 Rafale jets valued at ₹3.25 lakh crore. Deliveries are expected to commence from both French production lines and Indian lines by 2030-31.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** Rafale: A multi-role, twin-engine fighter aircraft manufactured by Dassault Aviation.
- **S&T:** Tejas Mk-1A and Mk-2: Indigenous Light Combat Aircraft (LCA) developed by HAL.
- **Fact:** Proposed deal value: ₹3.25 lakh crore for 114 aircraft.
- **Body:** Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL): India's public sector undertaking responsible for aircraft manufacturing.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges and strategic importance of balancing indigenous defense manufacturing with the acquisition of advanced foreign military hardware in India.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127073

Defence technology · Prelims + Mains · 28 Sept

HAL Excluded: Defence Ministry Picks Private Firms for AMCA Prototypes

Why in news: Defence Secretary RK Singh revealed that HAL was excluded from the AMCA prototype manufacturing project for the first time due to technical grounds, shifting focus toward private sector participation.

Key facts: The Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA) project involves three selected bidders: Tata Advanced Systems Limited, an L&T-BEL-Dynamatic consortium, and a Bharat Forge-BEML-Data Patterns consortium. The first flight of the AMCA prototype is scheduled for September 2028.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** AMCA: India's indigenous Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft project.
- **Fact:** First flight of the AMCA prototype is expected in September 2028.
- **Body:** HAL: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited is a public sector undertaking under the Ministry of Defence.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of involving the private sector in the manufacturing of advanced indigenous defence technologies like the AMCA for India's self-reliance.

Space technology (ISRO, missions) · Prelims + Mains · 28 Sept

ISRO and CNES are preparing to launch TRISHNA from Sriharikota in 2027

Why in news: ISRO and France's CNES are collaborating to launch the TRISHNA satellite in 2027 to map Earth's water resources and monitor the global water cycle.

Key facts: TRISHNA (Thermal infraRed Imaging Satellite for High-resolution Natural resource Assessment) will provide a resolution better than 60 metres from a Sun-synchronous orbit above 700 km. CNES provides the thermal infrared instrument, while ISRO develops the optical payload.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** TRISHNA: A joint satellite mission by ISRO (India) and CNES (France) scheduled for 2027.
- **S&T:** TRISHNA's Orbit: Operates in a Sun-synchronous orbit at an altitude of more than 700 km.
- **Fact:** TRISHNA Resolution: Aims to deliver a resolution better than 60 metres with multiple revisits per week.
- **S&T:** Vikas Engine: India's major rockets carry a French legacy through the Viking engine, which was transformed into the Vikas engine.

Mains question: Discuss how space-based remote sensing technologies can contribute to achieving Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) related to water security and climate change mitigation.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127237

Defence technology · Prelims · 29 Sept

Kaveri Derivative Engine Exceeds Target, Reaches 48.5 kN Thrust in Russian Trials

Why in news: DRDO's Kaveri Derivative Engine (KDE) exceeded its thrust target during high-altitude flight trials in Russia, marking a milestone for India's indigenous UCAV propulsion.

Key facts: The KDE was developed by the Gas Turbine Research Establishment (GTRE) for the Ghatak Unmanned Combat Aerial Vehicle (UCAV). It achieved a peak dry thrust of 48.5 kN during trials at the CIAM and Gromov Flight Research Institute in Russia.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** GTRE: Gas Turbine Research Establishment is a DRDO laboratory specializing in gas turbine engines.
- **S&T:** KDE: Kaveri Derivative Engine is designed to power the Ghatak UCAV.
- **Post:** CEMILAC: Centre for Military Airworthiness and Certification is the body responsible for certifying aircraft and engines.
- **Fact:** The KDE achieved a peak dry thrust of 48.5 kN, exceeding the initial target of 46 kN.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of indigenous propulsion technology in achieving 'Atmanirbhar Bharat' in the aerospace and defence sector.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127385

Biotechnology & health research · Prelims + Mains · 30 Sept

Omar Yaghi and team win Nobel Prize for extracting water in Death Valley

Why in news: Omar Yaghi and his team won the 2025 Nobel Prize in Chemistry for developing Metal-Organic Frameworks (MOFs) capable of extracting liquid water from arid air.

Key facts: The team successfully extracted liquid water from air with 14% humidity in Furnace Creek, Death Valley National Park, between August 19 and 23, 2022. The technology utilizes MOF-303, a material that can capture and release water molecules through adsorption and desorption cycles.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** MOF-303: A Metal-Organic Framework (MOF) used for atmospheric water harvesting.
- **Post:** Omar Yaghi: Saudi national and professor at UC Berkeley, winner of the 2025 Nobel Prize in Chemistry.
- **Place:** Furnace Creek: Located in Death Valley National Park, used as a testing site for water extraction.
- **Fact:** The device successfully extracted water from air with 14% humidity during the 2022 trials.

Mains question: Discuss how advancements in Material Science, specifically Metal-Organic Frameworks (MOFs), can address global water scarcity in arid and semi-arid regions.

Source: Times of India · satyadheesh.in/news/128317

IN-SPACe guidelines require Indian entities to seek authorization for hosted-payloads under Space Policy 2023

Why in news: IN-SPACe released guidelines under the Space Policy 2023 requiring Indian entities to seek authorization for hosted-payloads to ensure national security and treaty compliance.

Key facts: IN-SPACe released the guidelines on September 17, 2026. The DPIIT currently lists 440 startups in the space sector, and IN-SPACe has granted 113 authorizations to 52 Non-Government Entities.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** IN-SPACe: Indian National Space Promotion and Authorization Centre, the nodal agency for private sector space activities.
- **Fact:** DPIIT: Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, currently listing 440 space startups.
- **S&T:** Hosted-payloads: Instruments or equipment carried by a spacecraft and operated by a third party.
- **Post:** Space Policy 2023: The overarching framework governing India's commercial space sector.

Mains question: Discuss how the regulatory framework for hosted-payloads balances the promotion of private space exploration with national security and international treaty obligations.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128423

Environment & Ecology

Delhi bans non-compliant vehicles from November 1 under strict new Winter Action Plan

Why in news: The Delhi government and Ministry of Environment unveiled the Winter Action Plan 2026-27 to mitigate severe air pollution in the National Capital Region (NCR).

Key facts: The plan includes a 'No PUCC, No Fuel' campaign at 500 fuel pumps using ANPR systems. It mandates construction bans and work-from-home policies starting October 1 and November 1, respectively, involving agencies like CAQM and CPCB.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** CAQM: Commission for Air Quality Management is a statutory body for air pollution management in NCR.
- **Body:** CPCB: Central Pollution Control Board is the statutory authority for pollution control in India.
- **Fact:** ANPR: Automatic Number Plate Recognition systems are used to monitor non-compliant vehicles.
- **Place:** NCR: National Capital Region includes Delhi and surrounding districts of Haryana, UP, and Rajasthan.

Mains question: Discuss the effectiveness of multi-agency collaborative frameworks like the CAQM in tackling the recurring winter air pollution crisis in the National Capital Region.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127829

East and northeast regions record driest monsoon since 1901 at 1,017.1 mm

Why in news: The India Meteorological Department (IMD) reported that the 2026 southwest monsoon was significantly below normal, with the East and Northeast regions recording their driest monsoon since 1901.

Key facts: India's 2026 southwest monsoon recorded 759.4 mm of rain, which is 12.6% below the 868.6 mm normal. The East and Northeast region recorded 1,017.1 mm, the lowest since systematic records began in 1901.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India's 2026 southwest monsoon rainfall was 87% of the Long Period Average (LPA).
- **S&T:** El Nino is identified as a primary driver for the subdued monsoon rainfall in 2026.
- **Body:** The India Meteorological Department (IMD) is the nodal agency for monitoring and forecasting monsoon patterns in India.
- **Fact:** The southern peninsula recorded 542 mm of rain, the fourth lowest monsoon rainfall in that region since 1901.

Mains question: Analyze the impact of El Nino and climate change on the variability of the Indian monsoon and its implications for food security.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128578

Supreme Court rules out nationwide firecracker ban, accepts limited relaxation for green crackers

Why in news: The Supreme Court rejected a blanket ban on firecrackers, opting for a conditional relaxation based on CSIR-NEERI's recommendations for 'green crackers' to balance cultural practices with air quality.

Key facts: The Supreme Court accepted CSIR-NEERI's recommendation for Gen-2 green crackers, which reduce PM10 and PM2.5 pollution by 45%-60%. Only manufacturers holding Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation (PESO) licenses are eligible for registration.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** CSIR-NEERI: Council of Scientific and Industrial Research - National Environmental Engineering Research Institute
- **Body:** PESO: Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation regulates the manufacture and storage of explosives
- **Fact:** Gen-2 green crackers reduce PM10 and PM2.5 pollution by 45%-60% compared to traditional crackers
- **Place:** Delhi Government's Winter Action Plan 2026-27 was announced on September 29, 2024

Mains question: Discuss the conflict between individual cultural rights and the collective right to a clean environment in the context of air pollution management in urban India.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/128805](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/128805)

Internal Security

Supreme Court takes action on Delhi's gang-rape cases, echoes 2012 Nirbhaya failures

Why in news: The Supreme Court took suo motu cognizance of recent gang-rape cases in Delhi to address systemic law enforcement failures and public safety lapses.

Key facts: The Supreme Court, led by Justice JB Pardiwala, initiated action on recent rape cases including a minor's gang-rape on a sleeper bus. The court drew parallels to the 2012 Nirbhaya case, highlighting recurring failures in police accountability and public safety infrastructure.

Prelims pointers

- **Post:** Justice JB Pardiwala: Presiding judge in the Supreme Court's suo motu cognizance of Delhi rape cases.
- **Fact:** 2012 Nirbhaya Case: A landmark case in India that led to significant legal reforms and the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2013.
- **Body:** Suo Motu Cognizance: The power of the Supreme Court to take up a matter on its own motion without a formal petition.

Mains question: Critically analyze the systemic challenges in law enforcement and public safety infrastructure in urban centers, and suggest measures to ensure victim safety and police accountability.

Source: NDTV · [satyadheesh.in/news/126958](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/126958)

RK Singh, India's Defence Secretary, stated at NDTV's Defence Conclave 2026 that the government

Why in news: Defence Secretary RK Singh announced the fast-tracking of a limited batch of Zorawar light tanks to counter China's Type-15 tanks along the LAC.

Key facts: The Zorawar light tank was developed jointly by DRDO's CVRDE and Larsen & Toubro (L&T) since March 2022. The government plans to induct an initial batch of 18 tanks (out of 59 ordered) with lower protection levels to ensure continuous manufacturing while meeting army requirements.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** Zorawar: A light tank developed jointly by DRDO (CVRDE) and Larsen & Toubro (L&T).
- **Fact:** The first batch of Zorawar tanks to be inducted consists of 18 units out of a total order of 59.
- **Place:** The Zorawar tanks are specifically intended for use along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) in Ladakh.
- **S&T:** Type-15: A light tank used by China, which the Zorawar is intended to counter.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of indigenous defense manufacturing and 'incremental induction' in strengthening India's border security against high-altitude threats.

Terrorism & insurgency (J&K, North-East) · Prelims + Mains · 28 Sept

Shah Unveils PRAHAAR Strategy, Busting 40 Modules Linked to Bhatti Network

Why in news: Home Minister Amit Shah announced the 'PRAHAAR' strategy and the dismantling of the Shahzad Bhatti network, highlighting a shift toward multi-agency coordination in counter-terrorism.

Key facts: The government busted over 40 modules linked to the Shahzad Bhatti network, resulting in 350 arrests and 100+ FIRs across 15 states. The network was declared a terrorist organization under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA).

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** UAPA: Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act provides the legal framework for designating and prosecuting terrorist organizations.
- **Fact:** The operation involved 350 arrests and over 100 FIRs across 15 Indian states.
- **Body:** Extradition Portal: A new government initiative launched to expedite the return of fugitives from foreign countries.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of multi-agency coordination and legislative frameworks like UAPA in strengthening India's counter-terrorism architecture.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127298

Cyber security · Prelims + Mains · 30 Sept

Half of Indian cybercrime victims complain to police, 27% pay bribes

Why in news: The Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) 2026 highlights systemic corruption and informal reliance among cybercrime victims, revealing that 27% of victims pay bribes to ensure case processing.

Key facts: The SPIR 2026 report by Lokniti-CSDS and Common Cause found that while 50% of cybercrime victims report to police, 27% pay bribes. Bribes correlate with a jump in recovery rates from 12% to 41%, while 37% of victims rely on personal networks.

Prelims pointers

- **Report / Index:** SPIR 2026: Status of Policing in India Report published by Lokniti-CSDS and Common Cause
- **Fact:** 27% of cybercrime victims report paying bribes for case handling
- **Fact:** Recovery rates increase from 12% to 41% when bribes are paid
- **Fact:** Rural poor (51%) and women (35%) are more likely to pay bribes than urban affluent (12%)

Mains question: Discuss the challenges in policing cybercrimes in India, with special reference to the role of corruption and the reliance on informal networks by vulnerable sections.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128130

Practice — Mains questions

1. Analyze how the proposed Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act could impact India's strategic autonomy and its energy security goals. · GS2
2. Discuss the necessity of multi-stakeholder governance frameworks in regulating Artificial Super Intelligence to balance technological innovation with global safety standards. · GS2
3. Analyze the impact of El Nino and climate change on the variability of the Indian monsoon and its implications for food security. · GS3
4. Examine the constitutional conflict between the privileges of the legislature and the fundamental right to freedom of the press in India. · GS2
5. Discuss the importance of electoral integrity and the role of independent audits in ensuring the sanctity of the democratic process in India. · GS2
6. Discuss the conflict between individual cultural rights and the collective right to a clean environment in the context of air pollution management in urban India. · GS3
7. Analyze the challenges India faces in securing favorable trade terms with the United States amidst fluctuating global tariff regimes and regional competition. · GS2
8. Critically examine the role of Minimum Support Price (MSP) in ensuring food security and farmer welfare while addressing the fiscal implications on the national exchequer. · GS3
9. Examine how the development of Green Energy Corridors and Battery Energy Storage Systems is essential for achieving India's ambitious non-fossil fuel capacity targets by 2035. · GS3
10. Discuss the economic implications of India's rapidly aging demographic profile and the necessity of increasing female labor force participation to sustain growth. · GS3
11. Discuss the challenges in policing cybercrimes in India, with special reference to the role of corruption and the reliance on informal networks by vulnerable sections. · GS3
12. Discuss the significance of the UNICORN naval radar agreement and the FOIP framework in strengthening India-Japan maritime security cooperation. · GS2
13. Discuss the significance of India's deepening economic and technological ties with the UAE in the context of India's 'Look West' policy and energy security. · GS2
14. Discuss the constitutional and ethical implications of collecting religion-based demographic data by the state. Does such data collection compromise the principle of secularism? · GS2
15. Critically examine the Collegium system of judicial appointments in India. Does it ensure transparency and accountability in the higher judiciary? · GS2

Prelims quick revision

- **Fact:** The Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act proposes tariffs of up to 100% on specific imports.
- **Post:** S. Jaishankar serves as the External Affairs Minister of India.
- **Body:** The act targets countries importing Russian oil as a means of economic pressure.
- **S&T:** White House Accord on Super Intelligence: A voluntary pact between the US government and major AI firms for safety oversight.
- **S&T:** OpenAI, xAI, and Anthropic: Key private entities involved in the development of Large Language Models and Super Intelligence.
- **Act / Bill:** Ban Artificial Superintelligence Act: A legislative proposal aimed at prohibiting the development of super-intelligent AI systems.
- **Fact:** India's 2026 southwest monsoon rainfall was 87% of the Long Period Average (LPA).

- **S&T:** El Nino is identified as a primary driver for the subdued monsoon rainfall in 2026.
- **Body:** The India Meteorological Department (IMD) is the nodal agency for monitoring and forecasting monsoon patterns in India.
- **Constitution:** Article 19(1)(a): Guarantees freedom of speech and expression, including freedom of the press.
- **Constitution:** Article 194(3): Relates to the privileges of the House of the Legislature of a State.
- **Body:** Supreme Court: The highest judicial body in India, empowered to adjudicate on the constitutionality of legislative actions.
- **Act / Bill:** Representation of the People Act, 1950: Governs the preparation and maintenance of electoral rolls.
- **Constitution:** Article 361: Provides immunity to the President and Governors; the petition argues CEC should not have similar immunity.
- **Body:** Election Commission of India (ECI): Constitutional body responsible for administering elections.
- **Body:** CSIR-NEERI: Council of Scientific and Industrial Research - National Environmental Engineering Research Institute
- **Body:** PESO: Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation regulates the manufacture and storage of explosives
- **Fact:** Gen-2 green crackers reduce PM10 and PM2.5 pollution by 45%-60% compared to traditional crackers
- **Post:** Jamieson Greer: U.S. Trade Representative (USTR)
- **Fact:** Meeting date: September 30, 2026
- **Fact:** India's trade competitors in this context: ASEAN, China, and Bangladesh
- **Fact:** Wheat MSP for 2027-28 rabi marketing year: ₹2,610 per quintal
- **Fact:** Masur MSP for 2027-28 rabi marketing year: ₹7,390 per quintal
- **Body:** CACP (Commission for Agricultural Costs & Prices) provides recommendations for MSP fixing
- **Fact:** Total outlay for Green Energy Corridor Phase-III: ₹1,86,405 crore
- **Fact:** Target for renewable energy evacuation: 135 GW by FY 2032-33
- **Fact:** Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) target: 50 GWh
- **Fact:** India's current Total Fertility Rate (TFR) is 1.9.
- **Fact:** India is projected to become 'super-aged' by the year 2065.
- **Fact:** Annual births in India have dropped to 2.32 crore.
- **Report / Index:** SPIR 2026: Status of Policing in India Report published by Lokniti-CSDS and Common Cause
- **Fact:** 27% of cybercrime victims report paying bribes for case handling
- **Fact:** Recovery rates increase from 12% to 41% when bribes are paid
- **Intl. org:** FOIP: Free and Open Indo-Pacific is a strategic framework for maritime security and regional cooperation.
- **Fact:** The UNICORN naval radar agreement is a bilateral defense cooperation between India and Japan.
- **Place:** The Sea of Japan is a key maritime zone for Quad naval exercises.
- **Fact:** UAE's total investment target in India: \$100 billion
- **Fact:** Target bilateral trade between India and UAE: \$200 billion by 2032
- **Fact:** New investment tranche announced: \$25 billion
- **Body:** HLCDC: High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes formed by the Ministry of Home Affairs

- **Fact:** The committee seeks data spanning a 15-year period to analyze demographic trends
- **Place:** The committee visited Jammu and is scheduled to visit Maharashtra
- **Body:** The Collegium system is the mechanism used by the Supreme Court of India to recommend names for judgeships.
- **Post:** The Collegium currently comprises the Chief Justice of India and four other senior-most judges.
- **Fact:** The three recommended judges represent the Gujarat, Delhi, and Telangana High Courts.
- **Act / Bill:** UAPA: Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act provides the legal framework for designating and prosecuting terrorist organizations.
- **Fact:** The operation involved 350 arrests and over 100 FIRs across 15 Indian states.
- **Body:** Extradition Portal: A new government initiative launched to expedite the return of fugitives from foreign countries.
- **S&T:** Zorawar: A light tank developed jointly by DRDO (CVRDE) and Larsen & Toubro (L&T).
- **Fact:** The first batch of Zorawar tanks to be inducted consists of 18 units out of a total order of 59.
- **Place:** The Zorawar tanks are specifically intended for use along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) in Ladakh.
- **Post:** Justice JB Pardiwala: Presiding judge in the Supreme Court's suo motu cognizance of Delhi rape cases.
- **Fact:** 2012 Nirbhaya Case: A landmark case in India that led to significant legal reforms and the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2013.
- **Body:** Suo Motu Cognizance: The power of the Supreme Court to take up a matter on its own motion without a formal petition.
- **Body:** Indian Oil, BPCL, and HPCL are the three major public sector oil marketing companies in India.
- **Fact:** The mandate restricts households without BAA to 5kg or 10kg cylinders at market prices.
- **Post:** The Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas oversees the distribution of LPG subsidies.
- **Fact:** MDR of 0.4% applies to person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI payments above ₹2,000 starting October 15, 2026
- **Fact:** MDR is capped at ₹300 per transaction for payments of ₹75,000 and above
- **Fact:** Maharashtra accounted for 9.84% of UPI transactions by volume as of April 2026
- **Fact:** India's crude oil basket price in September: \$116.04 per barrel
- **Fact:** Real GDP growth rate in Q1 FY27: 7.8%
- **Fact:** Indian crude basket composition: Sweet crude (Brent-based) and Sour crude (Oman and Dubai grades)
- **Fact:** India's total external debt reached \$778.2 billion by June 2024.
- **Fact:** India's debt-to-GDP ratio moderated to 20.8% as of June 2024.
- **Fact:** August 2024 services trade exports were \$35.5 billion against \$18.9 billion imports.
- **Fact:** Proposed Deep Tech fund size: \$25 billion
- **Body:** IVCA: Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association
- **Fact:** Total funding recorded between 2015 and July 2026: \$11.4 billion
- **Place:** Kaliningrad: A Russian exclave located on the Baltic Sea, bordering Poland and Lithuania.
- **Post:** Mark Rutte: The current Secretary-General of NATO.
- **Fact:** Russia's nuclear arsenal is the largest in the world, governed by various arms control treaties.
- **Body:** IN-SPACe: Indian National Space Promotion and Authorization Centre, the nodal agency for private sector space activities.

- **Fact:** DPIIT: Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, currently listing 440 space startups.
- **S&T:** Hosted-payloads: Instruments or equipment carried by a spacecraft and operated by a third party.
- **Fact:** The US paused a USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan as a bargaining chip during negotiations with China.
- **Fact:** The US and China extended their trade truce by two months following the Washington summit.
- **Place:** Donald Trump is scheduled to visit China for the APEC summit in November 2025.
- **S&T:** MOF-303: A Metal-Organic Framework (MOF) used for atmospheric water harvesting.
- **Post:** Omar Yaghi: Saudi national and professor at UC Berkeley, winner of the 2025 Nobel Prize in Chemistry.

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